Don’t be a know-it-all
Be a learn-it-all

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GLOBAL AZURE 2026: Let’s Build the Future Together!

Governing Guest Access

with Entra ID | Identity Governance

MAU Billing · Entitlement Management · Access Reviews · Lifecycle Controls

Lightning Session · 30 Minutes · Demo Included

SESSION AGENDA

- 3 min — The Guest Governance Problem
- 3 min — Entra ID Governance – Quick Recap
- 4 min — MAU Billing Model Explained
- 3 min — What Triggers MAU Billing
- 4 min — The 4 Key Governance Controls
- 5 min — LIVE DEMO: Azure MAU Billing Setup
- 3 min — Pitfalls & Cost Control
- 5 min — Key Takeaways + Q&A

THE GUEST GOVERNANCE PROBLEM

?

How many guest accounts in your tenant?

- Guests invited once, never reviewed — stale access persists for years
- Access to Teams, SharePoint & LOB apps often untracked and ungoverned
- No offboarding process — partners leave, access remains
- Orgs skip governance due to licensing confusion or fear of unexpected costs

Guests are often the LEAST governed identities — yet they access your most sensitive data.

ENTRA ID IDENTITY GOVERNANCE – QUICK RECAP

Entitlement Management

Access packages that bundle resources. Define who can request, approve & auto-expire access.

Access Reviews

Periodic reviews of who still needs access. Reviewers confirm or revoke — automated outcomes. Now with added AI*

Lifecycle Workflows

Automate tasks when guest accounts are created, expire, or are removed from the directory.

Privileged Identity Mgmt

Just-in-time privileged access. Less relevant for guests, but available for elevated partner accounts.

THE MAU BILLING MODEL EXPLAINED

Monthly Active User (MAU)

MAU billing is a **pay-per-use model** for External Identities features in Entra ID.

- Linked to an Azure Subscription
- Entra P2 features won't be billed to guests
- Applies to external users (guests, B2C) only
- Charged per unique user authenticated that month
- No charge if the user does NOT authenticate

ID Gov License vs MAU Billing

For guest Identity Governance actions:

	ID Gov License	MAU Billing
Who pays?	Per member user assigned	Per guest who authenticates
Cost model	Fixed monthly	Variable (usage-based)
Cost	$7.00USD	$0.75USD per ACTIVE guest
Best for	Large internal teams	External guests & partners
Governance?	✓ Full features	✓ Full features

WHAT TRIGGERS MAU BILLING?

✓ DOES Trigger MAU Billing

- ✓ Guest user is included in an access review
- ✓ Guest uses an access package request portal
- ✓ Lifecycle Workflow runs against a guest user
- ✓ Member (sponsor) users completing access reviews
- ✓ Guest uses verified ID for access request

✗ Does NOT Trigger MAU Billing

- ✗ Guest account exists but never authenticates that month
- ✗ Admin views or manages the guest account in Entra portal
- ✗ Guest redeems an invitation link
- ✗ Creating/updating access packages (admin actions)
- ✗ Guest authenticates to access M365 / Teams / SharePoint

💡 Key Insight: Billing is based on authentication events, not identity count. Dormant guests cost nothing.

THE 4 KEY GOVERNANCE CONTROLS FOR GUESTS

1. Access Packages

- Bundle M365 groups, SharePoint sites, Teams & apps
- Guests self-request via My Access portal
- Built-in approval workflows & auto-expiry
- Perfect for partner onboarding at scale

2. Access Reviews

- Periodic recertification of guest access
- Assign reviewers: manager, resource owner, or guest themselves
- Auto-remove access on 'deny' or non-response
- Schedule quarterly reviews for all external users

3. Entitlement Management

- Define connected orgs for trusted partner domains
- Policies control which guests can request what
- Cross-tenant access policies integrate here
- Separation of duties between resource owners

4. Lifecycle Workflows

- Trigger tasks on guest account expiry or deletion
- Send reminders before access expires
- Revoke sessions, remove from groups automatically
- Audit trail for compliance and reporting

LIVE DEMO

~ 5 minutes

Azure MAU Billing Setup for Entra External Identities

1. **Entra Portal → Identity Governance**

   Navigate to entra.microsoft.com → Entra ID → ID Governance → Dashboard

2. **Guest access governance**

   In the Guest access governance tile, click the “Get started” button to turn on ID Governance guest access

3. **Azure subscription and resource group**

   Link an Azure subscription and a resource group

4. **Azure Cost Management – Set a Budget**

   Navigate to Cost Management → Budgets. Set a monthly budget alert for ‘Microsoft Entra External ID' meter.

5. **Review Current MAU Count**

   Back in Entra → External Identities → overview shows your current month's MAU consumption.

💡 *Tip for demo: Have portal.azure.com open and pre-navigated to External Identities before this slide.*

⚠ COMMON PITFALLS & COST CONTROL

PITFALL

Not having owner role on the subscription

The user linking the subscription must have Owner role on at least the resource group, if not the subscription

PITFALL

Not setting budget alerts

Without alerts, a spike in guest logins (e.g. a Teams meeting blast) can create unexpected charges. Set a $50 alert as a minimum.

PITFALL

Confusing MAU with P2 requirement

MAU covers governance features for external users only. Internal member users still need P2 if you want PIM or HR-driven provisioning.

PITFALL

Linking the wrong subscription

Linking a production subscription can mix identity costs with workload costs. Use a dedicated subscription for External ID billing.

TIP

Use Access Package auto-expiry

Set maximum duration on access packages (e.g. 90 days). This naturally reduces your active guest count and MAU costs.

TIP

Quarterly access reviews = natural cleanup

Auto-removing denied guests reduces MAU count and your attack surface simultaneously — governance and savings together.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- You CAN govern guests without ID Gov licenses for each guest user — MAU billing covers it.
- Provided your tenant has an ID Gov license for member users, you can govern guests.
- Entitlement Management + Access Reviews are your highest-value controls for guest lifecycle.
- Billing only triggers on active governance features. A guest who never logs in costs nothing — but is still a risk.
- Link a dedicated Azure subscription and set budget alerts before enabling governance at scale.
- Start with Access Reviews — they're the fastest win: reduce stale access AND control MAU costs.

Thank You!

Questions?

📖 learn.microsoft.com → Entra Identity Governance

🔧 entra.microsoft.com → ID Governance → Get started

💲 Microsoft Entra External ID → Entra Identity Governance

Session slides available at:
https://github.com/matthewjlevy/GlobalAzure/blob/main/GlobalAzure_GuestGovernance.pdf
#GlobalAzure

Governing Guest Access with Entra ID Identity Governance

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BY COMMUNITY • FOR COMMUNITY

Matthew Levy

Solutions Architect at Threatscape with expertise in Identity Governance

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